QAMAR SHAHZAD

Python / Django Backend Engineer | AI-Assisted Development & Automation | DevOps | RAG Solutions

Python · Django · DRF · PostgreSQL · Redis · Celery · n8n · LLM / Voice AI Integration · Proxmox · CI/CD . RAG Setups

Dubai, Business Bay, UAE | +971 52 973 3130 | qam600@gmail.com | qaam.work | linkedin.com/in/iamqam

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend-focused software engineer with 5+ years of hands-on experience designing, building, and operating production systems in Python and Django, within a 16-year career in travel and online operations. Specialized in REST API development, relational data modeling, and scalable backend architecture using Django, Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Celery for asynchronous task processing. Built and delivered multiple full-stack platforms (Tourism, Sports B2B, Accounting, B2B Commerce) with Django backends and Next.js frontends.

Increasingly focused on AI automation and LLM integration — building self-hosted, production-grade AI systems including a multilingual voice assistant for a travel platform (Kokoro TTS + LLM APIs), n8n-based workflow automation, and Claude / ChatGPT integrations that connect internal systems, booking engines, and customer-facing channels to reduce manual operational work. Strong DevOps foundation across managed cloud (AWS EC2/S3, Google Cloud) and self-hosted Proxmox infrastructure with Dockerized services and CI/CD pipelines. Focused on clean, maintainable code with attention to availability, scalability, security, and performance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Backend & API Development: Python, Django, Django REST Framework, REST API Design, PostgreSQL, Relational Data Modeling, Redis, Celery (Async Task Queues), Flask, Booking Engines, Payment Gateway Integrations, Custom CRM / Admin Systems

AI Automation & Integration: Self-Hosted Voice AI (Kokoro TTS + LLM APIs, Multilingual), LLM Workflow Orchestration, n8n Pipelines, Claude / ChatGPT Integrations, MCP / Tool-Calling Integrations, RAG-ready Architectures, API-based AI Business Process Automation

Full-Stack Development: Next.js, JavaScript, ntfy (Push Notifications), End-to-End Platform Delivery (Tourism, Sports B2B, Accounting, B2B Commerce)

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3), Azure, Oracle, Google Cloud VM, Proxmox Virtualization, Linux Server Administration, Docker, Application Deployment, Reverse Proxy / Web Server Configuration, SSL / DNS / Hosting Management

CI/CD & Code Quality: Jenkins Pipelines, SonarQube Code Quality Analysis, Nexus Repository Manager (Docker Image Caching), Git / GitHub, Automated Build & Deploy Workflows

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer — Python / Django, Cloud & AI Automation

Five Vertex Tourism, Dubai, UAE | Mar 2025 – Present

- **Architected and built four production platforms on one shared stack** — B2C tour and activity booking website (five.tours), B2B travel-agent portal, financial management application and a Flutter mobile app, all on Django REST Framework APIs, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery and Next.js.
- **Designed the B2B/B2C booking engine and REST APIs** — relational data models and endpoints for tours, activities, tickets, transfers, availability, pricing, customers and bookings, secured with scope-based API-key authentication for partner and internal integrations.
- **Built the financial and business management system** — transaction management, revenue reporting, booking analytics and management dashboards used for day-to-day operational and financial decisions.
- **Developed an AI Trip Designer using Claude tool-calling** — LLM function calls query live PostgreSQL inventory and stream itineraries to the Next.js frontend via Server-Sent Events from Django, with Redis session state; n8n handles side effects (Telegram alerts, CRM updates).
- **Built Fiva, a live multilingual voice assistant (voice.five.tours)** — real-time voice AI using Pipecat, faster-whisper speech recognition, the Claude API and Kokoro TTS, supporting English, Arabic, Russian, Spanish and Portuguese for booking and customer enquiries.
- **Created a custom MCP server for AI integration** — a Django/DRF adapter that exposes booking, customer, analytics and content APIs as secure AI tools, so assistants can query and act on live business data.
- **Automated business workflows with n8n and API integrations** — lead handling, notifications, CRM and messaging channel integrations, reducing repetitive manual operations work.
- **Ran cloud and DevOps for all platforms** — Proxmox virtualisation with Docker, Cloudflare Tunnel, MinIO object storage, GlitchTip error tracking and self-hosted mail (DKIM/SPF/DMARC); Jenkins CI/CD, SonarQube code quality and Nexus image caching; AWS and Google Cloud deployments. Also delivered technical SEO (JSON-LD structured data, llms.txt).

Backend Developer — Python / Django

Arabian Nights Tours, Dubai | 2020 – Mar 2025

- **Integrated AI chatbot and LLM-based automation into booking and customer-support workflows** — improving response efficiency, reducing manual handling, and laying the foundation for later AI-driven operational tooling.
- Built and maintained business-critical backend services using Python, Django, and REST APIs to support booking engines, reporting, operations, and customer-facing processes.
- Designed and maintained relational data models and database schemas in PostgreSQL, with Redis and Celery for caching and asynchronous task processing.
- Developed travel systems, booking engines, internal dashboards, and operational management platforms used daily by operations and management teams.
- Deployed and operated production applications on AWS (EC2 for compute, S3 for object storage) and Google Cloud VM, ensuring stability, uptime, and scalability, before transitioning core workloads to self-hosted Proxmox infrastructure.
- Integrated payment gateways and third-party APIs to improve business logic, response efficiency, and process automation.
- Worked closely with operational and management teams to translate business needs into practical, scalable backend solutions.

Web & Digital Marketing Executive

Arabian Nights Tours, Dubai | 2012 – 2019

- **Managed the company's WordPress and Shopify websites** — theme and plugin configuration, tour and package uploads, content creation and publishing, and on-page SEO.
- **Ran digital marketing campaigns** across Google Ads, Facebook and Instagram, with SEO/SEM and tracking through Google Analytics and Google Tag Manager.
- **Handled web hosting, domains, SSL and website maintenance**, working with the operations team on online bookings and customer enquiries — the foundation for moving into backend development from 2020.

Web & Online Operations Executive

Al Nasir Travel, Pakistan | 2008 – 2012

- Supported online business operations through website management, digital systems setup, and service promotion.
- Assisted in improving online visibility and the technical structure of business websites and digital assets.
- Managed web-related updates, content publishing, and online customer acquisition support.

KEY PROJECTS

- **Fiva — Multilingual AI Voice Assistant (live: voice.five.tours)** — Real-time conversational voice bot for booking and customer support, integrating Kokoro TTS with LLM APIs, deployed on self-hosted infrastructure. Supports multiple languages and connects to backend booking logic. Stack: Python, LLM APIs, Kokoro, Django/DRF, Proxmox.
- **Sports B2B Commerce Platform (Five Motion Sports)** — End-to-end B2B platform (fmsportz.com) with a Django REST API covering product catalogue, MOQ / lead-time management, and OEM workflows. Stack: Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, ntfy, Next.js.

EDUCATION

- Executive MBA – Hospitality & Tourism | National Institute of Business Management | 2017 – 2018
- Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) | Virtual University | 2009 – 2012

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Backend & Languages: Python, Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, REST APIs, JavaScript

AI / Automation: n8n, LLM APIs, Kokoro (Voice AI), Claude, ChatGPT, MCP / Tool-Calling, API Integrations

Databases & Async: PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, ntfy (Push Notifications)

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3), Google Cloud, Proxmox, Linux, Docker, Git, GitHub

CI/CD & Code Quality: Jenkins, SonarQube, Nexus Repository Manager

Frontend & Platforms: Next.js, HTML, CSS, WordPress, Custom CRM, Booking Engines, Payment Integrations